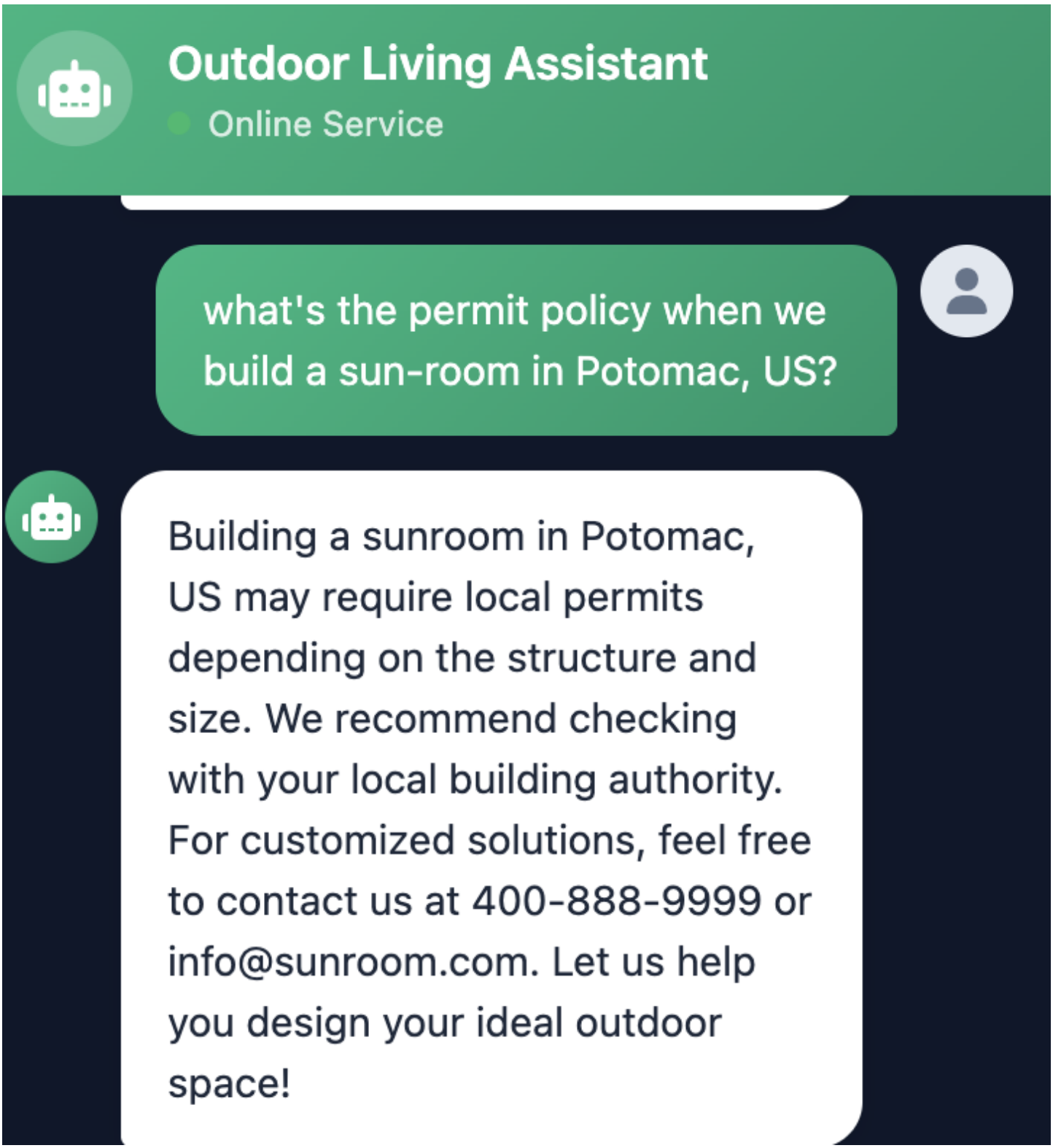
Testing between ChatGpt, Qwen, API (Qwen-turbo)

Question - what's the permit policy when we build a sun-room in Potomac, US?

Reply from API (temp = 0.7, token limit = 300)



Reply from API (temp = 0.7, token limit = 500)

estim

ibe y

Outdoor Living Assistant

Online Service

what's the permit policy when we build a sun-room in Potomac, US?

Building a sunroom in Potomac, US may require local building permits. We recommend consulting with a local contractor or municipal office for specific regulations. Our team can assist with design and installation once permits are obtained. Would you like a free design consultation?

Type your question...

Support Services

After-sales Service

Reply by Qwen, generated after about 1.5 min thinking:-)

⚠️ Critical Clarification First

*This answer assumes you refer to **Potomac, Maryland** (a census-designated place in Montgomery County). If you mean Potomac, Montana or another location, contact that specific jurisdiction's building department immediately.*

📍 **Potomac, MD has no independent government**—all permits are governed by **Montgomery County, Maryland**.

📜 Permit Policy Summary for Sunroom Construction

Requirement	Details
✅ **Permit Required?**	**YES, universally.** Sunrooms are classified as structural dwelling additions. *No exemption.* size, prefab kits, or "enclosed porches."
📍 **Zoning Compliance**	· Verify your property's zoning district (e.g., R-60, R-90 common in Potomac) via Montgomery County Zoning Map. · Confirm setbacks (front/side/rear), lot coverage limits, height restrictions (typically ≤3 · *Do not assume standard setbacks*—varies by zone and lot specifics.
🏘️ **HOA Approval**	**Mandatory first step** for most Potomac neighborhoods (Travilah, North Potomac, etc.). County often requires HOA architectural approval *before* accepting permit application. Re covenants early.
🏗️ **Building Code**	Must comply with: · 2021 IRC + Montgomery County amendments · 2021 IECC Energy Code: Glazing U-factor ≤0.30, proper insulation, air sealing · Structural engineering stamp required for foundations/wind loads · Separate electrical/plumbing permits if adding outlets, lighting, HVAC
🌳 **Environmental Checks**	· Floodplain? Check FEMA maps via DPS. · Tree preservation: Removal of trees >19" DBH requires permit/replacement. · Critical areas (streams, wetlands, slopes) trigger M-NCPPC/Maryland DNR reviews.
🏛️ **Historic Review**	If property is in a designated historic area (e.g., near Glen Echo corridor), Montgomery Cou Historic Preservation Commission review is required for visible alterations.

🔁 Typical Process

1. **Pre-Application**:
   - Contact HOA for design approval.
   - Schedule free pre-application meeting with DPS: DPS Appointments.
2. **Submit**:

- Apply online via ePermit Montgomery with stamped plans, site survey, energy docs, HOA letter.

3. **Review & Fees**:
   - Multi-department review (2–8 weeks). Fees ≈ $300–$1,000+ (based on project valuation).
4. **Inspections**: Foundation, framing, final.
5. **Certificate of Occupancy**: Required before use.

⚠️ Critical Pitfalls

- ❌ Skipping HOA approval → County application rejected.
- ❌ Assuming "small sunroom = no permit" → Violation risks fines, forced removal, resale issues.
- ❌ Ignoring energy code → Glass-heavy designs frequently fail without low-e glazing/insulation specs.
- ❌ Self-installing structural work → Montgomery County requires licensed contractors for framing, electrical, plumbing.

💡 Action Plan

1. **Confirm jurisdiction**: Use Montgomery County Property Lookup with your address.
2. **Contact DPS directly**:
   📞 (240) 777-0311 | dps@montgomerycountymd.gov
   🌐 DPS Sunroom/Room Addition Guide
3. **Hire locally experienced professionals**: Architects/contractors familiar with Montgomery County reviews drastically reduce delays.
4. **Document everything**: Keep HOA approvals, permit copies, inspection records for future resale.

> 📌 **Disclaimer**: Regulations change. This is informational guidance only. **Always obtain written confirmation from Montgomery County DPS** before design, purchase, or construction. Non-compliance may result in penalties, demolition orders, or title complications. When in doubt—ask the county first! 😊

Reply by ChatGpt. Generated almost instantly (don't know why).

Here’s a clear summary of **permit requirements for building a sunroom in Potomac, Maryland (United States)**. *Note*: Potomac is unincorporated Montgomery County, so county

rules apply.

🏡 1. **Building Permit Required**

Yes — in **Montgomery County, MD**, you **must obtain a building permit** before constructing a **sunroom/solarium/room addition**.

A sunroom is typically classified as a **room addition** or **alteration to the existing structure**, and is NOT exempt from permitting.

📜 2. **Which Permits Are Typically Needed**

You will generally need:

✔️ **Building Permit**

Required for:

- Structural construction
- Footers, foundation work
- Framing
- Walls, floor, roof extensions

✔️ **Electrical Permit**

If:

- You install lighting, outlets, ceiling fans, wiring

✔️ **Mechanical Permit**

If:

- You install HVAC equipment, vents, ductwork

✔️ **Plumbing Permit**

Rare for a sunroom **unless**:

- You add a sink, bathroom, or wet-bar

✔️ **Energy Compliance Documents**

Sunrooms must meet **energy efficiency standards** under the **Maryland Energy Code** (insulation, glazing, thermal performance).

🧱 3. **Code & Standards That Apply**

Your project must comply with:

✅ 2018/2021 International Residential Code (IRC) – structure

✅ Maryland Building Performance Standards

✅ Montgomery County amendments

✅ Energy Code (insulation, fenestration U-factor requirements)

📐 4. **Site Plans & Drawings**

When applying, you must submit:

✔️ Scaled site plan (showing property lines & setbacks)

✔️ Construction plans (floor, elevations, roof)

✔️ Foundation/structural details

✔️ HVAC / electrical layouts (if applicable)

✔️ Energy compliance forms

🚧 5. **Setback & Zoning Rules**

Sunrooms must obey:

🏠 **Setbacks**

Minimum distance from:

- Front property line
- Side & rear property lines

Exact distances depend on:

- Zoning district
- Lot size

Example: For many residential zones in Montgomery County:

- **Rear setback ~ 25 ft**
- **Side setbacks ~ 8–10 ft**

Check your specific zoning designation on county maps to confirm.

🧯 6. **Historic or Environmental Overlay**

If your home is:

✔️ In a **historic district**
✔️ In an **environmentally sensitive area**

you may need **additional approvals** (Historic Preservation Commission, environmental reviews).

🚪 7. **Contractor Licensing**

If you hire others to do the work:

✅ Contractors must be licensed & insured in Maryland

✅ Permits must list the licensed contractor

(Homeowner can pull the permit if owner-builder, but county requirements still apply)

🕐 8. **Inspections**

Once the permit is issued, you must pass a series of inspections at key stages:

📍 Footing/foundation

📍 Framing

📍 Electrical

📍 Mechanical

📍 Final inspection

Do not conceal work until inspections pass.

📠 9. **Fees**

Permit fees depend on:

- Project valuation
- Scope (electrical/mechanical/plumbing)

Montgomery County uses a **valuation-based fee schedule**.

📍 10. **How to Apply**

You can apply by:

🖥️ Online

Through **Permits & Licensing System**:
https://aca.accela.com/montgomerycounty

📞 In-Person

Montgomery County permit offices

You’ll need:

✔️ Property address

✔️ Tax ID (MC#)

✔️ Contractor info

✔️ Construction drawings

🧠 Quick Checklist

Before starting a sunroom project in Potomac:

✅ Check zoning & setbacks

✅ Draft architectural & structural plans

✅ Submit permit applications

✅ Address energy compliance

✅ Schedule inspections

📌 Important Notes

- Even small additions like sunrooms require compliance — **don’t assume “no permit”**.
- Unpermitted work can lead to fines and forced removal.
- Always consult the **Montgomery County Code Enforcement Division** if unsure.

If you want, I can also prepare:
📌 A **step-by-step permit application checklist**,
📌 A **summary of costs/fees** for similar projects,
📌 Or a sample set of required document templates.

Just let me know!

Take-away from the testing

1. The answer from both ChatGPT and Qwen looks good, but will be quite token consuming.
2. The token limit (300 vs 500) does not tell big difference. Shall we push up the limit, which will stand for the cost rising?
3. Is that due to the temperature setting?